

Mahta Ghafarianghadim

Ph.D. Candidate

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics (Expected 2026), Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

M.A. in Economics (2025), Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

M.A. in Energy Economics (2020), Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran

B.A. in Theoretical Economics (2018), Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental Economics, Health Economics, Policy Evaluation, Applied Microeconomics, Causal Inference

SKILLS

Econometric Methods: Instrumental Variables, Difference-in-Differences, Fixed Effects, Panel Data

Data & Programming: Stata, Python (pandas, numpy), SAS, QGIS, Excel

Data: National Center for Health Statistics (NCHS) restricted mortality data, Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS) survey data, Medicaid claims structure, Childcare and Parent Services (CAPS) administrative data, NASA satellite data

WORKING PAPERS

Job Market Paper (work in progress):

“Causal Impact of Air Pollution on Cardiovascular Disease Mortality in the U.S.”

- Provides causal estimates of the effect of PM2.5 on cardiovascular mortality at the county-month level using restricted-access NCHS mortality microdata linked to satellite-derived environmental measures.
- Systematically compares thermal inversion instruments across multiple specifications; model-level instruments at 110 and 320 meters above local ground yield valid estimates while fixed pressure level instruments fail due to terrain coverage problems.
- Using the preferred specification, a one-unit increase in PM2.5 raises cardiovascular mortality by 3.8 percent at the county-month level, ranging from 1.2 to 7.4 percent across specifications.
- Results are robust to alternative outcome transformations, PM2.5 measures, pollutants, and the pre-pandemic sample; plausibly exogenous analysis following Conley et al. (2012) confirms significance even if thermal inversions had a direct effect of up to 65–70 percent of the total reduced-form effect.

Working Paper:

“Mental Health and Functional Consequences of Smoking: A Causal Approach Using Misreporting Corrections”

- Estimates the causal impacts of smoking on mental health and functional limitations using BRFSS data and cigarette tax variation, highlighting the importance of accounting for smoking status misreporting in the evaluation of tobacco and public health policies.

Working Paper (with Garth Heutel):

“Assessing the Causal Impact of Air Pollution on Childcare Outcomes in the U.S.”

- Links restricted CAPS administrative records from Georgia’s Department of Early Care and Learning (DECAL), obtained through Georgia Policy Labs (GPL), with satellite-derived environmental measures to estimate the causal impacts of air pollution on childcare attendance outcomes.

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Faridzad, A., **Ghafarian Ghadim, M.** (2022). “CO₂ Intensity Decomposition Analysis in the Netherlands' Manufacturing Industry: An Application of Monetary and Physical Indicators.” *Environment, Development and Sustainability*, 25(8), 8799–8817

Ghafarian Ghadim, M., Faridzad, A. (2021). “Composite Energy Intensity Index Estimation in Iran: An Exploration of Index Decomposition Analysis.” *Polityka Energetyczna (Energy Policy Journal)*, 24(1), pp. 5–28

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant (2022–Present); Georgia State University

- Conduct research through Georgia Policy Labs (GPL) on the causal impacts of air pollution on childcare outcomes using large administrative and environmental datasets
- Apply instrumental variables and fixed-effects methods to construct high-frequency panel datasets
- Manage restricted-access administrative datasets under data use agreements, including CAPS administrative records from Georgia's Department of Early Care and Learning
- Explore the use of Medicaid claims data to examine respiratory diagnoses and emergency department utilization mechanisms

Research Assistant (2020–2021); Allameh Tabataba'i University

- Design Decomposition Analysis, Integrated Inoperability Input-Output (IIOM), and Mixed Input-Output (MIOM) methods

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“Estimating the Causal Impact of Air Pollution on Cardiovascular Mortality in the U.S.”

American Society of Health Economists ([ASHEcon](#)), Minneapolis, MN, June 2026

“Mental Health and Functional Consequences of Smoking: A Causal Approach Using Misreporting Corrections”

Presenting Author, Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management ([APPAM](#)) Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA, November 2025

HONORS & AWARDS

Dan E. Sweat Dissertation Fellowship for Policy-Related Research, Georgia State University (2026)

Dunn Fellowship and Research Fund, Georgia State University (2023–2025)

Ranked 1st among M.A. Economics students, Allameh Tabataba'i University (2020)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Session Chair, “Public Health and Economic Impacts of Environmental Stressors”, American Society of Health Economists ([ASHEcon](#)), Minneapolis, MN, June 2026

Judge, Georgia State University Undergraduate Research Conference (GSURC) and Summer Undergraduate Research Symposium (SURS), 2025

Session Chair, “Environmental Determinants of Health: Evidence from Air, Water, and Heat”, Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management ([APPAM](#)), Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA, November 14, 2025

Peer Review

Emerald Publishing, *International Journal of Energy Sector Management* (2026)

Springer Nature, *Journal of Population Economics* (2026)

Elsevier, *Economics & Human Biology* (2025)

ASHEcon conference abstract reviewer (2025)

Springer Nature, *Energy Efficiency Journal* (2020, 2021, 2024)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Georgia State University

Environmental Economics and Policy (ECON 4220, Online/Asynchronous), Summer 2026

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 2106, In Person), Fall 2025; Spring 2026

Fall 2025 instructor evaluations averaged 4.6/5.0 across 112 students

Spring 2026 instructor evaluations averaged 4.7/5.0 across 118 students

Teaching Assistant, Georgia State University & Allameh Tabataba'i University

Public Economics; Principles of Microeconomics; Intermediate Microeconomics (2022–2024)

SELECTED ACADEMIC TRAINING & WORKSHOPS

WEAI's Graduate Student Workshop, Denver, CO (Selected as department nominee; Funded participant, 2026)

NBER Environmental and Energy Policy and the Economy Conference, Washington, D.C. (2026)

Berkeley Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics, UC Berkeley (Funded participant, 2025)

REFERENCES

Dr. G. Heutel | Professor, Department of Economics, Georgia State University

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Dr. J. Marton | Professor, Department of Economics, Georgia State University

Email: marton@gsu.edu

Dr. R. Tchernis | Professor, Department of Economics, Georgia State University

Email: rtchernis@gsu.edu